PHILIPPINES · CROSS-BORDER PAYMENTS · 2027

The Philippine remittance economy goes digital

A USD 38 bn diaspora flow is migrating from cash counters to wallets and instant rails. OFW corridors, e-wallet economics, and ASEAN linkage define the 2027 opportunity.

COUNTRY	SECTOR	PUBLISHED	HORIZON
Philippines	Cross-Border Payments	May 2026	2027–2030

How we built this analysis

This report triangulates central-bank remittance statistics, World Bank corridor-cost data, regulatory disclosures, and operator filings into a forward read on Philippine cross-border payments. Every quantitative claim carries an inline source tag; **[Kira estimates]** marks figures derived from our own synthesis.

PRIMARY INPUTS

→ Central-bank & statistical data

Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas cash- and personal-remittance series, corridor splits, and digital-payment monitoring, anchored to the World Bank's quarterly remittance-price database.

→ Operator & channel reads

Disclosures and partnership announcements from leading wallets, banks, and money-transfer operators serving the inbound OFW flow.

→ Analyst triangulation

Where published figures diverge, our team reconciles to the most defensible mid-point and tags it as a KIRA estimate.

SCOPE & LIMITS

→ Unit of analysis

Inbound cross-border consumer payments to the Philippines — chiefly OFW remittances — and the rails that carry them. Trade and wholesale FX sit outside scope.

→ Currency convention

Flows reported in USD as filed by the BSP; peso references use a working rate of PHP 57 per USD and are directional only.

→ Forecast convention

Forward figures are directional scenarios anchored to documented base years, not point predictions. Ranges signal genuine uncertainty.

Contents

Philippine cross-border payments — a digitisation re-rating

A **USD 38–40 bn remittance pool** grows steadily, but the rails beneath it are changing fast. Cash counters cede ground to wallets, QR, and — by 2027 — instant regional linkage. **The next 24 months decide** which operators own the digitised corridor.

CASH REMITTANCES 2025	PERSONAL REMITTANCES 2025	US SHARE OF FLOW 2025	AVG CORRIDOR COST 2024
35.6 USD bn	**39.6** USD bn	**39.7** %	**~4** %
+3.3% YoY, record [BSP 2025]	~8.3% of GDP [BSP 2025]	largest corridor [BSP 2025]	above 3% SDG goal [World Bank 2024]
BSP	BSP	BSP	WORLD BANK

The market state

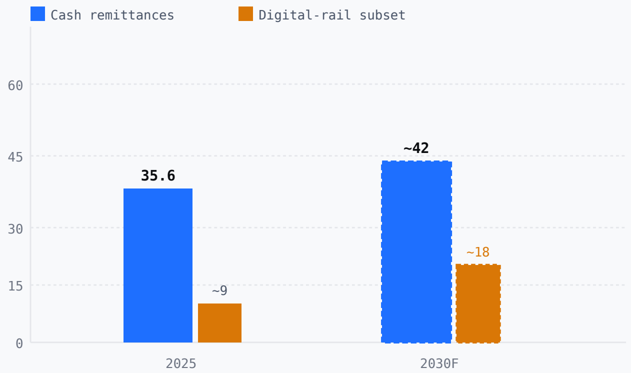
OFW cash remittances reached a record **USD 35.6 bn in 2025**, up 3.3% [BSP 2025]; personal remittances, which add in-kind transfers, hit USD 39.6 bn, near 8.3% of GDP [BSP 2025] [Ken 2025]. December alone set an all-time monthly high. The flow is structurally resilient — but its economics are being rewritten by digital rails.

Why now: cash gives way to rails

Wallets and QR now carry the marginal transaction: QR payments account for roughly **60% of digital transactions** by early 2026 [Thunes 2026], and digital-payment revenue is on a 13.9% CAGR toward USD 1.78 bn by 2033 [Ken 2025]. With average corridor cost still near 4% — above the 3% UN target [World Bank 2024] — the operator that compresses fees on a digital rail captures share.

Remittance flow and the digital rail shift USD BN

PHILIPPINES · USD BN · 2025 ACTUAL · 2030 FORECAST



SOURCE: BSP, KEN RESEARCH, KIRA TRIANGULATION · FORECAST = KIRA ESTIMATE ANCHORED TO 2025 BASE · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

SOURCE KEY · BSP 2025 = Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas remittance statistics, full-year 2025 · Ken 2025 = Ken Research Philippines digital payments & remittance market 2025 · Thunes 2026 = Thunes Philippines digital-wallet review early 2026 · World Bank 2024 = World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide database 2024 · Kira estimates = KIRA in-house analyst triangulation

Five strategic implications for market participants

Five forces reshape competitive dynamics through 2030. Each is anchored to documented market data and our synthesis of the Philippines' remittance and payments trajectory.

01 · DEMAND

The flow is steady; the rail is the contest

A record **USD 35.6 bn cash flow** grows low-single-digits [BSP 2025], so share gains come from migrating transactions onto cheaper, faster rails — not from market growth. Velocity and convenience, not headline volume, drive 2027 value.

Anchor: **+3.3%** remittance growth 2025

02 · COST

Closing the fee gap is the prize

Average corridor cost still runs **near 4%, above the 3% SDG goal** [World Bank 2024]. The operator that delivers sub-3% on a digital rail at scale converts price-sensitive senders and pressures legacy cash margins.

Anchor: **~4%** average send cost

03 · WALLETS

Super-apps own the receive side

Non-bank wallets hold **~39% of the digital-wallet pool** [Ken 2025], and partnerships extend reach to ~160 countries [Industry 2025]. Whoever owns the receiving wallet owns the customer relationship and the cross-sell.

Anchor: **~39%** non-bank wallet share

04 · RAILS

Instant regional linkage arrives by 2027

Project Nexus targets its **first live transaction by 2027** [BIS 2025], linking the BSP to ASEAN+India instant-payment systems. Operators must decide whether to plug into shared rails or defend proprietary corridors.

Anchor: **2027** first Nexus transaction

05 · TOKENS

Stablecoins move from sandbox to corridor

The BSP-sanctioned peso stablecoin PHPC **completed its regulatory sandbox in mid-2025** [BeInCrypto 2025]. Token rails promise cheaper settlement; regulation and off-ramp liquidity decide whether they reach mainstream OFW flows.

Anchor: **2025** stablecoin sandbox exit

SOURCE KEY · BSP 2025 = Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas remittance statistics 2025 · BIS 2025 = BIS Innovation Hub / Nexus Global Payments updates 2025 · BeInCrypto 2025 = BeInCrypto / Coins.ph PHPC sandbox reporting 2025 · Ken 2025 = Ken Research Philippines digital payments market 2025 · Industry 2025 = Philippine remittance-market analyst forecasts, consolidated 2025 · World Bank 2024 = World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide 2024

SECTION 06

The remittance engine

Nine million overseas Filipinos send home more than any peer economy at its size. The flow crossed **USD 35.6 bn in cash in 2025** and underwrites household consumption nationwide. This is not a backdrop to the payments story. It **is** the story.

A record flow, a concentrated corridor map, and cost gravity

OFW cash remittances have compounded for a decade and set a fresh record in 2025 [BSP 2025]. The flow is geographically concentrated — the **United States alone sends 39.7%** — and its cost still sits above the global target, framing the digitisation opportunity.

A decade of records

Cash remittances rose from USD 33.5 bn in 2023 to **USD 34.5 bn in 2024 and USD 35.6 bn in 2025** [BSP 2025]. December 2025 was the highest monthly figure ever recorded. Resilience is structural: the diaspora spans high-income and Gulf labour markets, smoothing the flow across cycles.

A concentrated corridor map

The US accounts for **39.7% of cash remittances**, followed by Singapore (7.3%), Saudi Arabia (6.6%), and Japan (5.0%) [BSP 2025]. North America and the Gulf anchor value; intra-ASEAN corridors are smaller but the fastest to digitise.

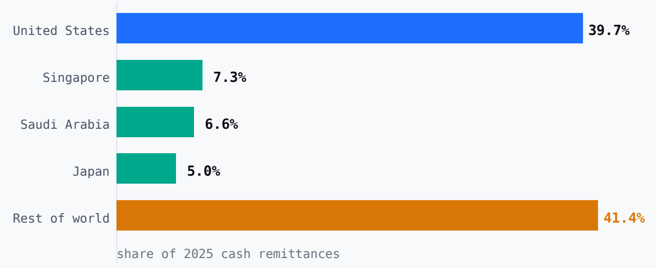
Cost gravity

Average send cost ran near **4% in 2024, above the 3% SDG target** [World Bank 2024], with quoted corridor fees ranging 1.8–4.6% [World Bank 2024]. Each basis point of cost compression is a direct transfer of value to OFW households.

Cash remittance corridors, 2025

% SHARE

PHILIPPINES · % OF CASH REMITTANCES BY SOURCE



SOURCE: BSP REMITTANCE STATISTICS 2025 · KIRA ANALYSIS · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

CASH REMITTANCES 2024

34.5 USD bn

+3.0% YoY [BSP 2025]

BSP

DEC 2025 MONTHLY

3.52 USD bn

all-time monthly high [BSP 2025]

BSP

CORRIDOR COST RANGE

1.8–4.6 %

vs 3% SDG goal [World Bank 2024]

WORLD BANK

SOURCE KEY · BSP 2025 = Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas overseas-Filipino cash remittance statistics, full-year 2025 · World Bank 2024 = World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide database, Philippine corridors 2024

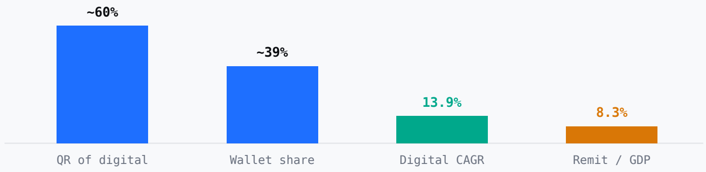
Wallet rails and QR capture the marginal transaction

The Philippines is one of Asia's fastest wallet adopters. As QR and wallet receipt become default, the remittance value chain shifts from cash payout networks toward **digital settlement** — the structural driver of the 2027 corridor economy.

Digital-payment signals

SIGNAL

PHILIPPINES · INDEXED SIGNALS · BASE YEARS VARY



SOURCE: THUNES, KEN RESEARCH, BSP · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

From counters to wallets

QR payments are about **60% of digital transactions** by early 2026 [Thunes 2026], and non-bank wallets hold ~39% of the wallet pool [Ken 2025]. The receive side has tipped digital faster than the send side.

QR share of digital	**~60%**
Non-bank wallet share	**~39%**
Digital-payment CAGR	**13.9%**
Digital pool 2033	**USD 1.78 bn**

THE RAIL ECONOMICS

A digital payout into a wallet settles in seconds at a fraction of cash-counter cost, while letting the receiving operator monetise downstream — bills, lending, savings, and merchant payments. The digital-payment revenue pool compounds at **13.9% toward USD 1.78 bn by 2033** [Ken 2025], even as the underlying remittance flow grows low-single-digits. The economics favour whoever controls the receiving endpoint.

THE COMMERCIAL READ

Cross-border partnerships now extend wallet reach to roughly **160 countries** [Industry 2025], collapsing the historical advantage of branch-heavy money-transfer networks. The contest is no longer about cash payout density; it is about send-side onboarding, FX spread, and the stickiness of the receiving super-app. The cash-to-digital shift is the single largest margin re-rating in the corridor.

SOURCE KEY · Ken 2025 = Ken Research Philippines digital payments & remittance market 2025 · Industry 2025 = Philippine remittance-market analyst forecasts, consolidated 2025 · Thunes 2026 = Thunes Philippines digital-wallet review early 2026 · BSP 2025 = Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas remittance & payments data 2025

SECTION 09

Competitive structure

The corridor is a three-tier contest. **Wallets, banks, and money-transfer operators** compete for the same OFW household — but on different rails. The wallets own the receive side, the banks own the balance sheet, and the legacy networks own the cash last mile that is shrinking.

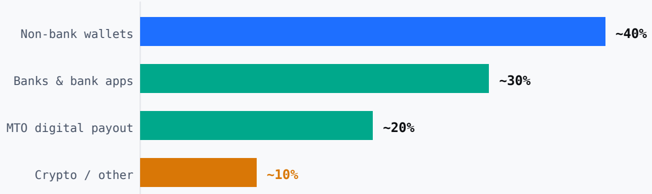
Market structure: wallet-led receive, bank-anchored balance sheets

Three tiers compete for the inbound flow. **Wallets dominate the digital receive side** [Ken 2025], universal banks bring capital and trust, and incumbent money-transfer operators defend the shrinking cash last mile. Partnerships, not single-channel dominance, define the structure.

Indicative channel mix of digital receipts

% MIX

PHILIPPINES · % OF DIGITAL REMITTANCE VALUE · KIRA VIEW



SOURCE: KEN RESEARCH, OPERATOR DISCLOSURES · MIX KIRA-ESTIMATED · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

Three tiers, one household

Non-bank wallets lead digital receipt at **~39% of the wallet pool** [Ken 2025]; banks bring balance-sheet depth and BDO posted **PHP 82 bn profit in 2024** [Industry 2025]; MTOs defend the cash last mile.

Non-bank wallet share	~39%
BDO 2024 profit	PHP 82 bn
Wallet partner reach	~160 ctry
Digital pool 2033	USD 1.78 bn

CORRIDOR LEADER

TIER · WALLET

GCash

G-Xchange (Globe / Mynt)

Tier	Wallet
Reach	~160 ctry
Channel	Super-app

Strengths: Largest wallet base, Ria & Viamericas tie-ups, real-time US/Canada inbound to wallet.

TIER · WALLET

Maya

Voyager / PLDT-backed

Tier	Wallet
Reach	TerraPay net.
Channel	Super-app + bank

Strengths: Digital-bank licence, TerraPay corridor reach, savings & credit cross-sell.

TIER · BANK

BDO & bank apps

BDO, Metrobank, UnionBank, RCBC

Tier	Bank
BDO profit '24	PHP 82 bn
Channel	Bank + app

Strengths: Balance-sheet depth, trust, end-to-end platform investment, branch + digital reach.

TIER · MTO

Western Union & peers

WU, MoneyGram, Remitly, Cebuana, LBC

Tier	MTO
Strength	Cash payout
Channel	Agent + digital

Strengths: Dense payout network, brand trust; pivoting to digital as cash share erodes.

SECTION 11

Regional corridors & instant rails

The next rail is shared, not proprietary. **Project Nexus** links the BSP to ASEAN+India instant-payment systems for a first live transaction by 2027, and a BSP-sanctioned peso stablecoin has already cleared its sandbox. The corridor is being re-plumbed at the infrastructure layer.

11.1 ASEAN LINKAGE

11.2 PROJECT NEXUS

11.3 STABLECOIN PILOTS

11.4 POLICY RISK

Shared instant rails and token settlement reshape the corridor

Two infrastructure shifts converge on the 2027 horizon: **multilateral instant-payment linkage** via Project Nexus, and **peso-backed stablecoin settlement** cleared through the BSP sandbox. Together they compress cost and time on the rails that carry OFW value.

ASEAN linkage and Nexus

The BSP is one of the ASEAN-5 central banks building **Project Nexus**, the BIS-led shared platform connecting domestic instant-payment systems [BIS 2025]. Nexus Global Payments incorporated in Singapore in March, with India joining; the **first live transaction is targeted for 2027** [BIS 2025].

Stablecoin pilots

Coins.ph's peso stablecoin **PHPC**, BSP-approved in 2024, completed its regulatory sandbox in mid-2025 [BeInCrypto 2025] [CoinGecko 2025]. Backed 1:1 by peso reserves and issued multi-chain, it targets cheaper, faster off-ramps into the local peso system.

The policy risk

Shared rails and token settlement raise new oversight questions — AML, FX, and settlement-finality risk concentrate on common infrastructure [AMRO 2025]. Adoption depends on regulator coordination as much as on technology.

Rail roadmap to 2027 TIMELINE

PHILIPPINES · CROSS-BORDER RAIL MILESTONES

- **2024 · PHPC BSP approval**
  First peso stablecoin pilot sanctioned
- **2025 · Sandbox completed**
  PHPC sandbox exit; Nexus entity incorporated
- **2026 · Nexus build-out**
  BSP, MAS, BNM, BOT, RBI integration
- **2027 · First live Nexus tx**
  Instant ASEAN+India linkage targeted

SOURCE: BIS INNOVATION HUB, COINS.PH, AMRO · KIRA ANALYSIS · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

NEXUS FIRST TRANSACTION
2027
ASEAN-5 + India [BIS 2025]
BIS

PHPC STABLECOIN
1:1 peso
sandbox cleared 2025 [BeInCrypto 2025]
BEINCRYPTO

LINKAGE MEMBERS
6
PH, SG, MY, TH, ID, IN [BIS 2025]
BIS

SOURCE KEY · AMRO 2025 = ASEAN+3 Macroeconomic Research Office, cross-border payments policy notes 2025 · BIS 2025 = BIS Innovation Hub / Nexus Global Payments updates 2025 · BeInCrypto 2025 = BeInCrypto / Coins.ph PHPC reporting 2025 · CoinGecko 2025 = CoinGecko PHPC stablecoin profile 2025

Outlook to 2030: steady flow, decisive rail migration

We expect remittance value growth to stay in the **low-to-mid single digits**, while the digital-rail share climbs sharply and instant regional linkage goes live. The operators that win are those that own the receiving endpoint and plug into shared rails early.

Base case

The broad remittance market compounds at about **6.2% from USD 41 bn in 2025 toward USD 56 bn by 2030** [Industry 2025]; cash remittances grow nearer 3% [BSP 2025], so the gap is digital-rail value. Digital-payment revenue compounds at 13.9% [Ken 2025].

Upside & downside

Upside: a live Nexus rail by 2027 and sub-3% digital fees pull volume off cash fast. Downside: a US labour or FX shock dents the dominant corridor, or fragmented regulation slows shared-rail and stablecoin adoption.

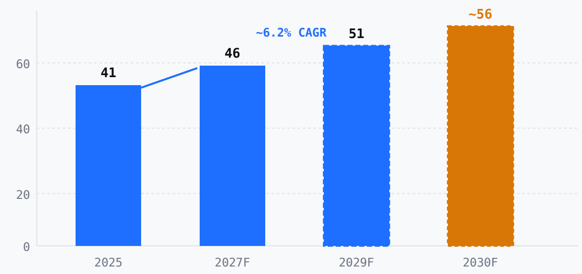
The strategic imperative

The corridor map is concentrated and the flow is steady; the variable is the rail. **Own the receiving wallet, compress the fee, and integrate with Nexus** when it goes live. Cash-tilted, network-heavy operators face the steepest adjustment.

Remittance market trajectory

USD BN

PHILIPPINES · USD BN · 2025–2030F



SOURCE: INDUSTRY FORECASTS, BSP · 2027–2030 FIGURES KIRA-ESTIMATED FROM ~6.2% CAGR · KIRA RESEARCH 2026

MARKET 2030 (BASE)
~56 USD bn
~6.2% CAGR [Industry 2025]
INDUSTRY

CASH FLOW TREND
~3 %
low-single-digit [BSP 2025]
BSP

DIGITAL REVENUE CAGR
13.9 %
to USD 1.78 bn 2033 [Ken 2025]
KEN

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Methodology & source index

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SOURCE INDEX

[1] Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas — overseas-Filipino cash- and personal-remittance statistics and corridor splits, full-year 2024 and 2025.

[2] World Bank — Remittance Prices Worldwide database, Philippine corridor costs 2024.

[3] Ken Research — Philippines digital payments, remittance and wallet-apps market 2024–2030.

[4] Consolidated Philippine remittance-market analyst forecasts, market size and growth 2025–2030.

[5] Thunes — Philippines digital-wallet adoption and QR-payment review, early 2026.

[6] BIS Innovation Hub / Nexus Global Payments — Project Nexus multilateral instant-payment linkage updates 2025.

[7] ASEAN+3 Macroeconomic Research Office — regional payment-connectivity and policy-risk notes 2025.

[8] BeInCrypto — Coins.ph PHPC peso stablecoin sandbox and approval reporting 2024–2025.

[9] CoinGecko — PHPC peso-pegged stablecoin profile and reserve disclosures 2025.

[10] Operator disclosures — GCash, Maya, BDO and money-transfer-operator partnership and results announcements 2024–2025.

[11] KIRA Research — in-house analyst triangulation across the above.